

Key to staying healthy is diet

India's **apex medical research body**, the Indian Council of Medical Research (ICMR), **released** new **dietary** recommendations for Indians, **pointing out** that food and lifestyle choices alone may be to blame for over half the disease burden in the country. **A balanced diet** must have no more than 45% of the calories from cereals, and pulses, beans and meat should be limited to 15% of the meal's calories. The rest should come from nuts, vegetables, fruits and milk, the recommendation **stated**. **Consumption** of salt, sugar and ultra-processed foods **must** be limited and oils and fats should be used in **moderation**. The 17 dietary guidelines, **in a nutshell**, **seek to nudge** people into consuming foods with essential nutrients and limiting those that contribute to what has been an **explosion** of lifestyle diseases, such as **obesity** and diabetes.

This **surge** in **preventable** disease **has** been well **documented**. The ICMR guideline notes healthy diets and adequate physical activity could prevent up to 80% of type-II diabetes and a **substantial** proportion of **coronary heart disease**. Most Indians today consume meals containing an excess of carbohydrates, snack mostly on ultra-processed foods, and finish it off with **saccharine desserts**. Meals are **often** cooked in excess or unhealthy oils, clarified butter or fat. Together, they create an unhealthy **cocktail** that **leads to** excess calorie **intake**, **triggering** fat **build-up**, **driving up** blood vessel-choking cholesterol, and creating or **exacerbating deficiencies** in **micronutrients**. It is easy to imagine this **anecdotally** – what proportion of your plate is made up of carbs such as rice or rotis? How sweet is your tea? And how often do you reach for a bag of chips?

The **challenge** of fixing the diet of any population **is** not easy by any measure. India is one of the grain bowls of the world, making carbohydrate-heavy cereals and starchy vegetables cheap. Then there is the **march** of **modernity** with its quick-service, **gig-worker-delivered**, discounted fast food and ready-to-eat meals. Adding to this is a population that is increasingly **sedentary**. It is about time India's **policymakers** and health authorities **double down on advisories** such as the new dietary recommendations to **stem** this **slide** in public health. Nutrition labels and classification of unhealthy foods will be crucial, as will public **infrastructure** that makes walking, exercising or cycling easy. But the biggest change needs to come from within — it must start with educating oneself on what to eat and how much to eat.

[Practice Exercise]

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.

Vocabulary

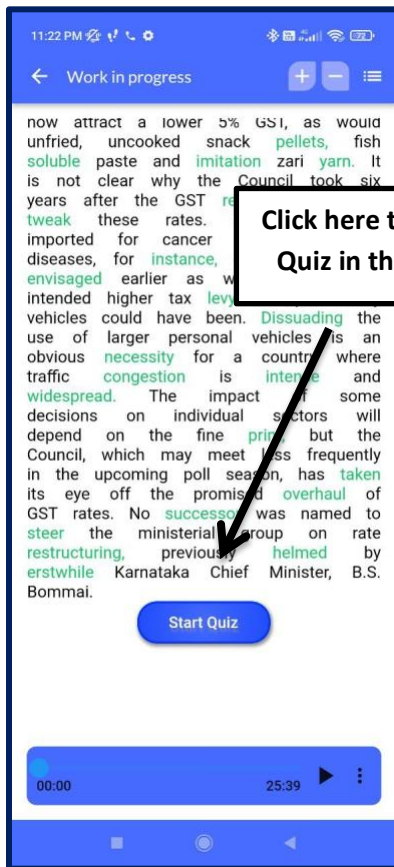
1. **Key** (to) (noun) – Solution, source, basis, answer कुंजी
2. **Apex** (adjective) – Supreme, peak, pinnacle, summit, top, height सर्वोच्च
3. **Dietary** (adjective) – Nutritional, alimentary, nutritive, dietetic, food-related खाद्य-संबंधी
4. **Point out** (phrasal verb) – Highlight, indicate, mention, specify, show इंगित करना
5. **A balanced diet** (noun) – Eating a wide variety of foods in the right proportions, and consuming the right amount of food and drink to achieve and maintain a healthy body weight संतुलित आहार
6. **State** (verb) – Declare, specify, express, mention, articulate व्यक्त करना
7. **Moderation** (noun) – Restraint, temperance, self-control, balance, prudence संयम
8. **In a nutshell** (phrase) – Simply, briefly, in summary, in short, concisely संक्षेप में
9. **Seek** (to) (verb) – Attempt, try, aim, aspire, strive प्रयास करना
10. **Nudge** (verb) – Prompt, encourage, coax, urge, prod प्रोत्साहित करना
11. **Explosion** (noun) – Sudden increase, eruption, upsurge, leap, अचानक वृद्धि
12. **Obesity** (noun) – Overweight, corpulence, fatness, bulkiness, heaviness मोटापा
13. **Surge** (noun) – Rise, increase, upsurge, escalation, spike वृद्धि
14. **Preventable** (adjective) – Avoidable, avertable, stoppable, thwartable, forestallable रोकने योग्य
15. **Documented** (adjective) – Recorded, reported, registered, noted, catalogued अच्छी तरह से प्रलेखित
16. **Substantial** (adjective) – Considerable, significant, major, sizeable, ample पर्याप्त
17. **Coronary heart disease** (noun) – Heart disorder, cardiovascular disease, heart ailment, cardiac disease हृदय रोग
18. **Saccharine** (adjective) – Sweet, sugary, syrupy, cloying, honeyed मीठा
19. **Dessert** (noun) – Sweet, pudding, treat, confection, sweet course मिठाई
20. **Often** (adverb) – Frequently, regularly, commonly, habitually, repeatedly अक्सर
21. **Cocktail** (noun) – Mixture, blend, combination, concoction, fusion मिश्रण

22. **Lead** (to) (verb) – Cause, result in, bring about, contribute to, precipitate वजह बनना
23. **Intake** (noun) – Consumption, ingestion, input, absorption, uptake सेवन
24. **Trigger** (verb) – Activate, initiate, provoke, set off, spark शुरू करना
25. **Build-up** (noun) – Accumulation, collection, pile-up, agglomeration, mass संचयन
26. **Drive up** (phrasal verb) – Increase, raise, escalate, inflate, heighten बढ़ाना
27. **Exacerbate** (verb) – Worsen, aggravate, intensify, increase, magnify बिगाड़ना
28. **Deficiency** (noun) – Shortage, lack, insufficiency, scarcity, deficit कमी
29. **Micronutrient** (noun) – Trace element, dietary mineral, vitamin, nutrient सूक्ष्म पोषक तत्व
30. **Anecdotally** (adverb) – Informally, through stories, unofficially, personally, experientially किस्सागोई से
31. **March** (noun) – Progress, advance, forward movement, journey, trek प्रगति
32. **Modernity** (noun) – Contemporary times, modern times, the present age, newness, modernism आधुनिकता
33. **Gig-worker-delivered** (adjective) – a person who works temporary jobs typically in the service sector as an independent contractor or freelancer
34. **Sedentary** (adjective) – Stationary, inactive, sitting, non-moving, desk-bound निष्क्रिय
35. **Policymaker** (noun) – Legislator, official, decision-maker, regulator, authority नीति निर्माता
36. **Double down on** (phrase) – Reinforce, intensify, strengthen, deepen, solidify दोगुना प्रयास करना
37. **Advisory** (noun) – Guidance, recommendation, counsel, suggestion, directive सलाहकार
38. **Stem** (verb) – Halt, stop, arrest, check, contain रोकना
39. **Slide** (noun) – Decline, fall, slip, downturn, descent पतन
40. **Infrastructure** (noun) – Facilities, systems, framework, services, structure अवसंरचना

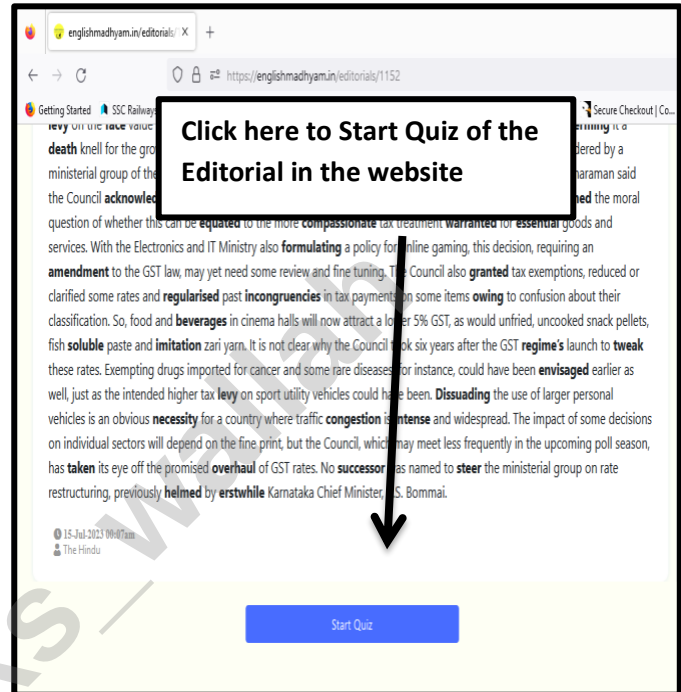
Summary of the Editorial

1. **Introduction of New Guidelines:** The Indian Council of Medical Research (ICMR) has released new dietary recommendations for Indians.
2. **Focus on Diet and Lifestyle:** These recommendations emphasize the significant role of food and lifestyle choices in contributing to over half the disease burden in India.
3. **Caloric Distribution:** A balanced diet should derive no more than 45% of calories from cereals.
4. **Protein Sources:** Pulses, beans, and meat should account for only 15% of a meal's caloric content.
5. **Importance of Variety:** The diet should also include nuts, vegetables, fruits, and milk.
6. **Restrictions on Harmful Ingredients:** There is a strong recommendation to limit the consumption of salt, sugar, and ultra-processed foods.
7. **Moderation in Fats:** Oils and fats should be used sparingly.
8. **Nutrient-Rich Foods:** The guidelines encourage the consumption of foods that are rich in essential nutrients.
9. **Limiting Unhealthy Foods:** There is an emphasis on avoiding foods that contribute to lifestyle diseases like obesity and diabetes.
10. **Impact on Non-communicable Diseases:** Adhering to these dietary guidelines could prevent up to 80% of type-II diabetes and a significant percentage of coronary heart diseases.
11. **Current Dietary Patterns:** Most Indians consume diets high in carbohydrates and ultra-processed foods, with excessive use of unhealthy fats.
12. **Health Risks:** Such dietary habits lead to excessive calorie intake, fat build-up, increased cholesterol, and micronutrient deficiencies.
13. **Economic and Modern Influences:** Carbohydrate-heavy diets are prevalent due to the affordability of cereals and starchy vegetables, compounded by the availability of fast food and ready-to-eat meals.
14. **Call for Policy Action:** There is a need for stronger health advisories and policies, including nutrition labeling and public infrastructure to support physical activities.
15. **Self-Education and Change:** The ultimate change must start with individuals educating themselves on proper diet and portion control.

Practice Exercise: Banking Pattern Based



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